

How do you create and manage a virtual machine in VMware ESXi?

To create a virtual machine, I first access the **ESXi server through the vSphere Web Client**. Then I go to the Virtual Machines section and select **Create a New Virtual Machine**.

During the creation process, I configure the VM's **name, compatibility, guest operating system, datastore, CPU, memory, hard disk, network adapter, and CD/DVD drive**.

I need to select the correct guest operating system, such as Linux or CentOS, and choose a datastore where the virtual machine will be stored. I also need to make sure that the resources I assign to the VM are appropriate for the available resources on the ESXi host.

For the operating system installation, I can upload an **ISO image** to the datastore and connect that ISO to the VM's CD/DVD drive. I can select **Connect at Power On** so the VM can boot from the ISO when it starts.

After reviewing the configuration, I click **Finish** to create the virtual machine. Then I can power it on and install the operating system.

After the VM is created, I can manage it through vSphere Client. As an administrator, I can monitor the VM and modify resources such as **CPU, memory, and disk**, depending on my permissions. Regular users may have more limited permissions.

So, the overall process is:

vSphere Client → Create VM → Configure resources → Select datastore → Attach ISO → Finish → Power On → Install OS → Manage VM

Easy version to memorize

“To create a virtual machine in ESXi, I use the vSphere Web Client and select Create a New Virtual Machine. I configure the VM name, guest OS, CPU, memory, storage, and network. Then I upload or select an ISO image and connect it to the VM's CD/DVD drive. After reviewing the settings, I create and power on the VM and install the operating system. As an administrator, I can then monitor the VM and modify its resources based on my permissions.”

Important interview terms:

VM = virtual computer

ESXi = hypervisor

Datastore = storage location for VMs

ISO = operating system installation image

vSphere Client = management interface

CPU / Memory / Disk = VM resources

How do you change the hostname of an ESXi host?

To change the hostname of an ESXi host, I use the **ESXi Direct Console User Interface (DCUI)** rather than the vSphere Web Client.

First, I access the ESXi console and press **F2**, then log in using the root password. Next, I select **Configure Management Network** and go to **DNS Configuration**.

By default, the hostname may be obtained automatically. I select the option to use a specific DNS server address and hostname, and then enter the new hostname, for example **ESXi1**.

After that, I apply the changes and restart the management network. Once the changes are applied, the new hostname appears in the ESXi host information.

In a corporate environment, each ESXi host should have a proper and unique hostname so administrators can easily identify multiple hosts. In a lab environment, using names such as **ESXi1** and **ESXi2** also helps avoid confusion.

The hostname can also be part of a **fully qualified domain name (FQDN)**. For example, in a company domain, the server could be named **ESXi1.ABC.com**.

Easy version to memorize

“To change the ESXi hostname, I go to the ESXi console, press F2, log in with the root account, and select Configure Management Network. Then I go to DNS Configuration and enter the new hostname. After applying the changes, I restart the management network. A proper and unique hostname is important, especially when managing multiple ESXi hosts.”

Remember the steps

F2 → Configure Management Network → DNS Configuration → Hostname → Apply Changes → Restart Management Network

Example:

localhost.localdomain → ESXi1.localdomain

Corporate example:

ESXi1.ABC.com

What are VMware Tools, and how do you manage VM resources and snapshots?

VMware Tools is a set of tools installed inside a virtual machine to improve communication between the guest operating system and the ESXi host. It allows ESXi to get more detailed information about the VM and provides functionality such as graceful shutdown and reboot. VMware Tools also provides drivers that improve the operation of devices such as the mouse and keyboard.

To install VMware Tools, I select the virtual machine in the vSphere Web Client, go to **Actions** → **Guest OS** → **Install VMware Tools**, and then complete the installation inside the guest operating system. A reboot may be required for the changes to take effect.

As a VMware administrator, I can also modify the resources assigned to a virtual machine. These resources include **CPU, memory, hard disks, network adapters, USB controllers, and other virtual hardware**. Depending on the resource and configuration, the VM may need to be powered off before making changes.

For example, if a database administrator requests additional disk space, I can increase the virtual disk from the ESXi side. However, increasing the virtual disk does not automatically make the additional space available inside the guest operating system. I may also need to extend the partition or filesystem inside Windows or Linux.

A **VM snapshot** captures the state and data of a virtual machine at a specific point in time. It can be useful before performing activities such as patching, upgrades, or testing. If something goes wrong, I can revert the VM to the snapshot.

However, a **snapshot is not a backup**. Snapshots should not be used as a replacement for a proper backup solution. Also, keeping too many snapshots can affect VM performance, so they should be used only when needed.

In simple terms, **VMware Tools improves communication between the VM and ESXi, VM resources can be adjusted according to requirements, and snapshots provide a point-in-time state that can be used to roll back changes.**

Short version to memorize

“VMware Tools is installed inside a virtual machine to improve communication between the guest OS and ESXi and provide features such as detailed guest information and graceful shutdown. As a VMware administrator, I can modify VM resources such as CPU, memory, disk, and network according to requirements. I can also use snapshots before patching or making major changes so I can revert the VM if something goes wrong. However, snapshots are not a replacement for backups.”

Key interview points

VMware Tools	→ Guest OS ↔ ESXi communication
→ Better drivers	→ Guest information
→ Graceful shutdown/reboot VM Resources	→ CPU
→ Memory	→ Disk
→ Network	→ USB and other virtual hardware
Snapshot	
→ Point-in-time state	→ Useful before patching/testing
→ Can revert changes	→ Not a backup
→ Avoid keeping too many snapshots	